FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-29-19002

Issue Title : Potential Hydraulic Tube Low Clearance Condition with Structure in the Engine Strut

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	2911-00	-8, -9
Other Model(s)	**ECCN**	
	9E991	

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
03/25/2019	03/25/2019	03/22/2019
Estimated Completion Date	**Next Update Date**	

Applicability

All 737 MAX line positions prior to 7423, with the following exceptions: 5728, 6250, 6744, 6798, 7163, 7260, 7263, 7273, 7285, 7318, 7323, 7326, 7346, 7351, 7365, 7371, 7376, 7386, 7388, 7389, 7391, 7396, 7400, 7403, 7405, 7408, 7410, 7411, 7413, 7415, 7418, 7419, 7420, and 7421.

Description

This Fleet Team Digest (FTD) article has been generated to inform 737 MAX operators of reported hydraulic leaks in the area of the left and right engine aft pylon fairings. Furthermore, this article summarizes the Root Cause/Corrective Action (RCCA) process carried out to resolve this issue.

Background

A 737 MAX operator reported discovery of a hydraulic leak in the area of the left engine aft pylon fairing. They were able to isolate the location of the leak area (via borescope) to the aft section of the hydraulic tube run within the aft pylon fairing where the hydraulic tubes make a 90 degree upward turn at the rear spar. Evidence of fluid leakage was observed in a chafed region common to one of the hydraulic tubes in the area. Upon removal of the aft pylon fairing, maintenance personnel found evidence of a hydraulic tube riding against the fairing structure. This riding condition ultimately resulted in the aforementioned external hydraulic leakage. For reference, Boeing provided the attached document containing additional details of the insufficient clearance condition.

Status

As a result of the aforementioned reported condition, the Boeing In-Service Investigations team initiated an RCCA investigation on production 737 MAX aircraft. Production and delivery center line checks revealed multiple instances of low/zero clearance conditions common to either the right or the left engine pylon hydraulic tubing. In order to rectify this issue, Boeing mechanics were instructed to trim the adjacent upper chord(s) to achieve adequate hydraulic tube clearance, after which the aircraft is considered to be fully compliant with engineering requirements.

In order to provide similar corrective action coverage on in-service aircraft, a Boeing Service Bulletin (737-29-1130) has been published containing the following:

- Remote Visual Inspection (RVI) procedures to inspect for the low clearance condition

- Aft fairing structural trimming procedures to rectify the low clearance condition (if present)

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Interim Action

None, at this time.

Final Action

As stated above, Boeing published Service Bulletin 737-29-1130 to provide inspection and rectification instructions for aircraft listed in the Applicability section above.

NOTE: Boeing considers the corrective measures provided in aforementioned service bulletin to be a permanent/final fix for the subject low clearance condition. Further repetitive inspections after completing the actions provided in the service bulletin are not required or recommended at this time.

Milestones

Note: Target dates are based upon currently available status and have risk of future revision.

Root Cause Established: 27-FEB-2019 (Complete)

Production Incorporation: 27-FEB-2019 (Complete)

Service Bulletin Available: 22-MAR-2019 (Complete)

Parts Available: 22-MAR-2019 (Complete)

Operator Action

Boeing highly recommends that operators of impacted 737 MAX aircraft carry out the steps provided in Service Bulletin 737-29-1130 at the next convenient opportunity. The reported low clearance condition may result in hydraulic fluid leakage in the area of the aft pylon fairing, which is a no-dispatch condition. Furthermore, the steps necessary to correct this condition include removal of the engine plug/nozzle and the entire aft fairing, which may result in significant aircraft ground time to accomplish (especially if the event occurs at an outstation).

NOTE: Boeing recommends that operators have spare stock of the hydraulic tube assemblies and vapor barrier seals listed in the Parts List (below) prior to performing the procedures provided in the aforementioned service bulletin.

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Illustrated Parts Catalog (IPC)	54-52-51-60, Item 330/335		03/22/2019
Illustrated Parts Catalog (IPC)	54-52-04-01, Items 215/220/225/230		03/22/2019
Illustrated Parts Catalog (IPC)	54-52-04-30, Items 120/125/130/135		03/22/2019
Service Bulletin (SB)	737-29-1130		03/22/2019

Parts List

Part Name	Boeing Part Number	Supplier Name	Supplier Number
Hydraulic Tube Assembly	272A3151-2005/-2010		

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Vapor Barrier Wing Seal	313A6612-1/-2		
Vapor Barrier Tube Seal	313A6612-3/-4		
Upper Chord, Outboard	313A6712-5/-6		
Upper Chord, Inboard	313A6712-7/-8		

Related Categories

- AOGs : Events that cause a significant Airplane On Ground (AOG) condition
- Dispatch Reliability Issues : Issues that cause revenue flight delays and cancellations

Attachments:

a) Hydraulic Tube Low Clearance - Figures

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